First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: Temporary Hours: M-F 9AM-12PM
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: By Appointment
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent pastoral matters call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Scripture Reader: Doug Klette

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST + THAT THEY MAY ALL BE ONE +

"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

May 12, 2024

10 am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Dr. Kevin Dirth, Choir Director
Monica Newton, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555
info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

Seventh Sunday of Easter May 12, 2024

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words**:** "While you'll feel compelled to charge forward it's often a gentle step back that will reveal to you where you and what you truly seek." — Rasheed Ogunlaru

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude

Welcome and Announcements

Call To Worship

One: Within this community

All: We experience God's unconditional love

One: Within this community

All: We rejoice in the risen Christ

One: Within this community

All: We awaken to the Holy Spirit

One: Within this community

All: We join together in worship

Morning Prayer[1] **(Unison)**

Ever present God, we are grateful that you meet us right where we are. Speaking our language and giving us the blessed assurance that you are with us. We look forward to the glory that awaits us, trusting that Christ will guide us to our heavenly home. In his name, we pray. Amen.

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!

If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).

If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]UCC, Worship Ways

Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

Announcements Continued:

NOTICE OF INFORMATIONAL MEETING May 19, 2024

Notice is hereby given that an Informational Meeting of the First Congregational Church of St. Albans, Vermont, will be held on May 19, 2024, immediately following the Sunday service. This notice is given in accordance with the provisions of the by-laws requiring three Informational Meetings a year, one of which is to be held in May, and two-weeks' notice for such meetings.
The business for the Informational Meeting is to 1) inform the Congregation about the affairs of the church, 2) provide the opportunity to ask questions, and 3) to discuss any issues and concerns.

In Their Shoes : May 18 at 1pm
Taylor Park
Guided walk by Samaritan House around St. Albans to raise awareness and compassion for our unhoused neighbors.

Annual Church Picnic – June 8, noon
At the Brown's camp on the Lake in West Swanton. There is a sign-up sheet at Coffee Hour. Directions and carpooling info to follow.

Ecumenical Pride Sunday Worship
June 9 @ 10:30
Taylor Park
YES 10:30

Zoom Bible Study
Our next Bible Study will meet on May 15; 7-8PM
Text: Acts 2:1-21
Join us at any time, call Pastor Jessica.

Hymn*

"Holy, Holy, Holy" NCH 277

Prayer of Confession[1] **(Unison)**

Life-giving God, we find joy in your newness of life through Jesus Christ. Help us to feel the joy of inhaling and exhaling the breath of life in every season. Transform us when we come together as your beloved and diverse creation. Guide us in our praise as we seek your saving love toward a world where there is peace and justice for all. Amen.

Pause for Reflection

Words of Assurance

Passing of the Peace

THE MESSAGE

Time with Children of All Ages

Anthem *I've Got Peace Like a River* Arr. Peter Amidon
Traditional African American Spiritual

Scripture Readings
Psalm 1 & John 17:6-19

Morning Reflection
Union

Hymn*

"Sweet Hour of Prayer" NCH 505

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Choral Call To Prayer

Hear Our Prayer, O lord D. Welpton

Pastor's Prayer~

Lord's Prayer

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen.

Choral Response To Prayer

"Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on thee."
Scottish Psalter, 1615

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*

"In the Midst of New Dimensions" NCH 391

Benediction

Postlude

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

- Mary Bostwick and Alice Drislane Thank You for all your hard work supporting the Welcome Home Initiative.
- Larry Bruce, Jan Johnson, Park Newton, Greg Beeman, Paula Kane, Alan and Hadley Shannon Thank You for moving forward with next phase of the Capital Campaign.

Martha's Kitchen Food Drive

We are collecting the following items for Martha's Kitchen items need to be in May 19!
Ground Coffee, Iced Tea Mix, Sugar,Powdered Creamer

Music Notes:

I've Got Peace Like a River is an African-American spiritual. Spirituals began on the fields and the slaves would sing to pass the time of day. It was also a great way to pass messages along and share the gospel.

This song uses water as a simile to describe peace, joy and love. The river simply finds a way to go around or over obstacles. It just keeps flowing. Peace is something that can be continually flowing in our lives despite our circumstances or the obstacles that may get in our path.

Open Mic

May 18, 7-9pm
Everyone is welcome!

Wi-Fi:

Sanctuary
sanctuary123

